

Autism Early Signs Checklist

For Parents — Ages 12 Months to 5 Years

IMPORTANT: This checklist is for AWARENESS ONLY. It is NOT a diagnostic tool. Only a qualified developmental pediatrician can diagnose autism. If you notice several of these signs, consult a doctor promptly.

By 12 Months	Observed?
Does not respond to name when called	☐ Yes ☐ No
Does not babble or make sounds	☐ Yes ☐ No
Does not point at objects of interest	☐ Yes ☐ No
Does not wave bye-bye	☐ Yes ☐ No
Does not make eye contact consistently	☐ Yes ☐ No
By 18 Months	Observed?
Does not use any single words	☐ Yes ☐ No
Does not show objects to share interest (showing, not asking)	☐ Yes ☐ No
Does not imitate simple actions	☐ Yes ☐ No
Does not play simple pretend games	☐ Yes ☐ No
Unusual reactions to sounds, textures or tastes	☐ Yes ☐ No
By 24 Months	Observed?
Does not use 2-word phrases spontaneously	☐ Yes ☐ No
Loss of previously acquired language or social skills	☐ Yes ☐ No
Does not follow simple 2-step instructions	☐ Yes ☐ No
Repetitive movements (hand flapping, rocking, spinning)	☐ Yes ☐ No
Lining up toys rather than playing with them	☐ Yes ☐ No
Ages 3-5 Years	Observed?
Prefers to be alone — limited interest in other children	☐ Yes ☐ No
Repeats words or phrases out of context (echolalia)	☐ Yes ☐ No
Insists on same routine — distressed by small changes	☐ Yes ☐ No
Intense, unusual interests in specific topics or objects	☐ Yes ☐ No
Difficulty with transitions between activities	☐ Yes ☐ No
Unusual posture or gait	☐ Yes ☐ No
Difficulty understanding others' emotions	☐ Yes ☐ No

What to Do Next

- ✓ Consult your pediatrician or developmental doctor immediately — do not wait
- ✓ Early intervention (before age 3) gives the BEST outcomes
- ✓ Ask for referral to developmental pediatrician, child psychiatrist, or neurologist
- ✓ Start speech therapy evaluation even while waiting for diagnosis
- ✓ Visit neurosaathi.co.in for free screening tests, doctor search and expert guidance